

3.4.5 Costume designer

Costume designs may include masks, hair and make-up as well as clothing.

Students who have chosen costume design as a specialism are expected to:

- learn how to design and realise costumes that contribute positively to the overall effect of the performance and are fully aligned with the dramatic aims of the group
- develop interpretative skills, creativity and inventiveness, creating meaning for an audience
- develop the ability to produce designs capable of establishing character
- develop the ability to produce designs capable of establishing period, location, or contributing to mood/atmosphere
- develop the ability to select the appropriate materials to realise costumes showing an understanding of eg fabric, texture, trimmings, accessories
- develop the ability to create costumes showing an understanding of colour, shape, appropriate fit, period details, ethnic authenticity, movement constraints, ornamentation
- develop the ability to create costumes showing an understanding of the dramatic intentions of the piece, individual performer interpretations, theatrical devices
- adopt the latest safe working practices.

Where students include make-up and hair in their designs they are expected to:

- develop the ability to select appropriate materials to realise their make-up design showing an understanding of different types of make-up eg grease-paint, liquids, powders, facial hair, eyelashes, gum, putty, prosthetics, stage blood
- develop the ability to create character through make-up: aging, fantasy characters
- develop the ability to create hairstyles appropriate to character, period, age, ethnicity.

It is the student's costume **design** that is assessed. Although students are expected to assemble the costume(s) when possible, this will not form part of the assessment.